

Kith Creation

Changeling includes 13 “primary” kiths for players to choose from, plus several more “minor” kiths in Chapter Ten. In addition, players can take on the roles of the inanimae, the Nunnehi, and the Menehune. Surely that’s enough options for players?

No, it’s not. The kiths and Gallain presented in this book are extensive, but they don’t begin to scratch the surface of the depth and variety of mythological beings that could conceivably count as Kithain, not to mention that players might come up with their own faerie beings. Hence, we present this section on creating new kiths.

Creating a new kith is a six-step process. It should involve the player creating the kith with the Storyteller — no point doing a lot of work on an amazing new kith if the Storyteller wants an all-boggan chronicle! Likewise, the Storyteller should tell the player up front if she has particular restrictions. For instance, she might decide that magic that affects time is the sole province of the Chronos Art, and therefore require that original kiths avoid Birthrights that include such magic.

Step One: Concept

First, conceptualize the kith. If you’re taking inspiration from mythology, literature, film, or some other media, take some time to think about what it is about the presentation of the potential kith you find compelling. Is it the visual effects surrounding the character in film? The clever way they put nosy mortals in their place? You might feel that a fairy creature from a legend should, by rights, be represented in the world of **Changeling: The Dreaming**, without having a specific “hook” — that’s fine, too! Try and nail down, though, your reasons for wanting to bring this new kith into the Dreaming.

The concept for your new kith doesn’t have to be coherent, and it doesn’t have to be playable or “balanced” or even include any mechanics at all, at this point. For now, just write

down the things you think are awesome. If some things on the list contradict other things, that’s perfectly acceptable. Dreams don’t make sense without some greater context, most of the time, but they can be great inspiration.

Think of concept in terms of:

- ⑤ **Appearance:** How does the kith appear, chimerically speaking? What nonhuman features does it have, if any? What challenges do those features suggest? Be careful of suggesting that all members of a kith belong to a particular ethnicity or nationality, but if the kith only has a few members, it’s by no means unreasonable to suggest that they are concentrated in a given region.
- ⑤ **Magic:** What kind of magic does the creature or being use in the inspirational stories or media? If you’re making up this kith out of whole cloth, what kind of magical talent seems cool to you? Don’t try and think in World of Darkness or **Changeling** terms yet, just note what the creature is capable of. If you’re taking inspiration from a beach-dwelling being that can summon hurricanes, go ahead and write that down. Yes, a playable character probably can’t summon such storms, but it’ll give you a direction.
- ⑤ **Dreams:** What kind of dreams inspired this being? Some Kithain resonate with nightmares, some with dreams of freedom and bliss, and some with dreams of a more carnal nature. Thinking about the dreams that led to this kith’s genesis can influence Birthrights and Frailties, general temperament, and court predilection (no one says redcaps *have* to be Unseelie, for instance, but most of them are).
- ⑤ **Human Life:** Remember that all Kithain begin life as human beings, and become changelings via the Chrysalis. What kinds of people might emerge from the Chrysalis belonging to this new kith?

Step Two: Role in the Dreaming

The next step is to bring your new kith into the world of **Changeling: The Dreaming**. To do this, you need to think not only about the mythology behind the kith (or whatever you are using as inspiration), but how the kith will fit into the World of Darkness as a whole.

The first and probably most important question is: How long has this kith been around? If your inspiration is from mythology or folklore, it makes sense that the kith have some history. That doesn’t mean that the changelings need to be especially numerous. They might be confined to a particular region, or have once been more common but stopped undergoing the Chrysalis until recently, for whatever reason. They might, however, be just as common as eshu, pooka, or any other kith — you just need to talk with your Storyteller and make sure that adding a new “core” kith into Kithain society isn’t going to throw a wrench into the chronicle’s works.

Look through the history of the Kithain (described in Chapter One), and imagine how the kith might have fit in. If the kith was around during the Accordance War, what role did it play? It’s not reasonable to think that *every* member of the kith chose one side or the other, but you can draw some

Dreams Do Not Follow Rules

“A foolish consistency,” wrote Emerson, “is the hobgoblin of little minds.” The process that we set out here to create new kiths can, in most cases, be used to “reverse engineer” the existing kiths... but exceptions exist. The very last step in the kith creation process is not “make sure everything is perfectly balanced with regards to game mechanics and that no kith is more powerful than any other,” but rather “make sure the kith represents your vision for it, and will be interesting and fun to play.”

Throughout this process, please remember to mentally append “unless breaking this rule makes for a more interesting character” to anything that seems to apply as a blanket statement.